06. Gold Rush Line

Nova Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/goldrush.ts

Where it is now

2.6 km: main street by the railway, level crossings, mesa or mine, broken trestle jump, blast cut from lap 2. Laps are short (37-48 s).

What is wrong

The train is something to wait for, not something to race on. Laps are too short.

Core mechanic

The train. A long moving train you race beside, on top of and through. You can drive up a ramp onto it, run along its roofs, jump between its cars and use it as a moving bridge across the canyon.

Signature moments

- Boarding the train: a ramp onto the flat cars, along the roofs, off before the tunnel.
- Mine carts: rails where the kart locks on and you only control speed and lean; lean wrong on a bend and you are thrown.
- The canyon: if the train is on the bridge you drive across on it; if not you take the long way.

Layout changes

- Lengthen to 3 km with a longer canyon section.
- Make the mine a rail-lock section.
- Add boarding ramps at two points beside the line.

Lap changes

- Lap 2: dynamite opens the blast cut.
- Last lap: the train runs faster and the gaps between cars widen.

Engine work needed

- Moving road pieces: the train as a drivable, moving deck.
- Locked-on rails (mine carts).
- Rivals that time boarding.

Rivals

- Rivals board the train when it is in reach and skip it when it is not.
- Rivals lean on the mine-cart bends.

Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.
- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.